Staff answers and case guide

Scope of the examples

Invented teaching cases prepared 30 October 2026. These examples do not describe real jobs or rules for all workplaces.

Exact outcome: I can compare at least three ways of working and explain which features fit my preferences.

E12 includes small/medium businesses, public sector, large employers and self-employment. The cases distinguish employer type, work status and pattern. They are combinations, not four exclusive categories. A small or large employer could use other patterns; self-employed work could also be hybrid or on site.

Cases A and B

Field	A small bakery	B hospital ward
Type and status	Small business; employee.	Part of the public sector in this case; employee.
Pattern and place	Fixed early weekday shifts at the bakery.	Day/evening shifts and some weekends on the ward.
Flexibility	Changes need manager agreement. Fixed days may help planning.	Rota ahead; swaps need agreement and cover.
Support	Task demonstration/checks in a small team; limited people free at once.	Training and a lead on each shift; busy times affect help.
Security or gap	Agreed weekly hours; duration not stated. Ask exact times/contract terms.	Agreed hours; contract length not stated. Ask rota notice and cover.

Similarity: both sample roles work on site in teams (A/B). Difference: A’s times are the same agreed weekdays; B’s rota varies. Neither pattern is universally better. The ward case involves supplies only, with no clinical task or practical instruction.

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Cases C and D and fit examples

Field	C warehouse planning role	D self employed repair worker
Type and status	Large employer; employee.	Own business; self-employed.
Pattern and place	Hybrid after training: two office days and three remote days each week.	Booked work at customer sites, with admin too.
Flexibility	Agreed weekdays/hours; planned place changes. No any-time promise.	Can suggest times; customers and tasks affect bookings.
Support	Check-ins and a contact. Kit, connection and workspace needed.	Arranges training and outside help; no employer-supplied lead in this case.
Security or gap	Agreed hours; length not stated. Ask kit provision and remote support.	Bookings, income and costs can vary. Ask about steady work and available help.

Examples of justified fit

Set days: A or C may fit, with A's early starts or C's remote-work needs as trade-offs. Team support: A, B or C may fit in different ways; the card does not promise instant help. More say over bookings: D may fit, with customer needs, admin and variable bookings as limits. Varied hours: B may fit a stated preference, but exact shifts and notice need checking.

Valid personal example: "I like set weekdays. A could fit because the days stay the same. I would check the early start time." Valid practice reasoning uses the same structure but must be recorded as hypothetical. Preferences can change, and several options can fit.

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Checks and misconceptions

Retrieval and model

Recall source label and limit from prior prepared-card research. Neutral fallback: one example does not describe every job. After the model: a small-business label does not determine all hours; hybrid refers to a mix of work places, not unlimited choice of time.

Main hinge

B is correct. C describes one planning role with agreed office/remote days and hours. It does not allow every warehouse worker to work remotely. Re-model job task, place and time if needed; then use the parallel hinge.

Parallel hinge

B is correct. D can suggest times, but customers and bookings constrain the plan. It does not promise constant work or full control. Ask for flexibility and security evidence; retain supported work if insecure.

Misconceptions

Employer size/type does not guarantee security. Particular terms and circumstances matter. Flexibility has dimensions: time, place or task may vary separately. Self-employment brings choices and responsibilities; it does not guarantee income or no constraints. A preference is not a permanent identity or a measure of someone's worth.

Supported and Floor

Use one heading across A/B/C before moving on. Floor key A, A, B, A, B, A. Ask for card clues and an actual or practice preference with a reason. Labels alone are insufficient. Log answers supplied by an adult separately from reading or scribing access.

Safe discussion

Use the generic cases without real employer claims. No pressure to share household income, work history or health. Do not tell a learner that a pattern is unsuitable because of a diagnosis or support need. Ask which arrangements or support would help.

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Evidence and feedback guide

Core evidence

J12 calls for employer/work-pattern comparison. The exact outcome requires at least three ways of working and explained fit to preferences. In this pack, collect three case patterns under common headings, labels beside claims, and a feature–preference–reason link. The trade-off or question is an added cautious-choice check; record it separately from the core outcome. M12 tests one justified preference, so also check breadth of comparison.

Secure and partial evidence

Secure: “A and B are on site; A keeps the same weekdays while B has changing shifts. C mixes office and remote days. I value knowing my days, so A could fit, but I need its start time.” Check support and security discussion too. Partial: three names without features; only two patterns; a preference with no reason; or a copied model. Hypothetical fit alone does not establish the learner’s personal preference.

Precise next steps

“Add a third way of working.” “Compare the same feature in both cases.” “Link the case feature to what you value.” “Name the detail you need to check.” Give one next step and keep the learner’s response.

Access and independence

Normal reader, scribe, typing or aids do not by themselves reduce independence of thought. Record actual answer prompts separately and fade them where secure. Keep a private response route. If the learner chooses a practice preference, bank the comparison and offer a later private opportunity for the personal-fit element.

Portfolio and marking

Retain comparison, case labels, preference type, reason, support and revision in the Careers Portfolio/action plan. Offer to the Communication portfolio. VF verbal feedback; WS supported; I independent; NS next step; // self-edit; ? read back; E actual banked evidence; R after Voice, Audience, NS and response in the same colour, on the same page or usual mode.

Fidelity boundary

Exact G12 outcome, I12 sequence and K12 routes retained. Generic invented cases meet the owner’s unnamed-employer requirement. No real employment terms are verified. Week 4 formative; Week 6 mixed source marking; Week 7 assessing.

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